between the global North and global South. Thus, he argues for closer cooperation between emerging countries for building a multipolar world order. Hence, the time has come for the international south countries to increase their relations. Even Russian leaders have also expressed the same view on changing global politics. Apart from that, Russia started shouldering China on various global issues. Because, again, in 2007, Putin discussed that Russia and China share several positions in the international arena and are driven by the same goals: our efforts are to maintain and strengthen the principles of the multipolar setup to preserve the strategic balance in the world. Further, Putin asserted that the Russia–China interaction would help to build just international order (Putin 2007). It paved the way for Russia and China to grow their international relations. At the same time, Russia and China have been branded as antagonistic countries of global peace and stability. Therefore, Russia and China tried to build regional groups to share common concerns with other like-minded nations. Thus, Russia had to create alternative power centers in international relations. Russia needed to pursue a multipolar world order in international relations to survive and regain independent status. Over time, NATO started to expand its Eastward side, strategically located close to Russia. Since NATO isolates Russia and China and creates threats and insecurity for them, the United States has attacked many allies of Russia like Yugoslavia, Afghanistan, and Iraq. Russia opposed the attacks on Afghanistan, Iraq, NATO's war with Yugoslavia, and the United States attempt to gain clout in Russia's strategic areas, like the Asia–Pacific region, Central Asia, Baltic States, and the near abroad part of Russia. Further, the American plan for a missile defense system was opposed by both Russia and China. Yet, America went ahead with it (Ambrosio 2007).

All these incidents made Russia and China rethink the current global order. Furthermore, Russia and China issued a 'Joint Statement of the People's Republic of China and Russian Federation on major international issues' on May 23, 2008. In this statement, both countries reiterated that the world is undergoing a remarkable transformation and that peace, development, and cooperation have become essential elements of the present international relations. With this, the trend to establish a multipolar world order became inevitable (Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the People's Republic of China 2008). China's foreign policy since Jiang's leadership has acknowledged that a singular and unchecked superpower can be very dangerous, as exemplified by the US invasion of Iraq without UN sanction and the US/NATO actions in Kosovo (Guerrero 2011). Later, President Putin, at the G-20 meeting on September 5, 2013, in Saint Petersburg, at the sideline meeting, remarked while mentioning the importance of the Eurasian Union that a multipolar world would emerge soon. In that, Russia and China would play a significant role.